

SpaceX

Latest Thoughts on Key AI Innovations; Cursor Acquisition, Frontier Models, & Enterprise Opportunity

SpaceX's AI ambitions are coming into sharper focus & we are increasingly positive on Grok. The company officially closed its [acquisition of Cursor](#) on 8/14, a milestone we view as an important step in building out its enterprise AI capabilities. Cursor brings [~\\$4B of ARR](#) (as of June 2026), with ~75% coming from businesses, which should help streamline SpaceX's go-to-market strategy & provide valuable data for model training. Importantly, we have already seen the benefits of Cursor data incorporated into Grok's supplemental training, with tangible improvements in recent model performance. Grok 4.6, released earlier this month, improved +5 points on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index versus Grok 4.5 despite arriving just about one month later, & trails only Anthropic's Claude Fable 5 & Claude Opus 5 on the leaderboard. The combination of both frontier intelligence & meaningfully lower cost vs peers places Grok 4.6 on the Pareto frontier, which should support stronger adoption. SpaceX is leveraging these increasingly capable models to develop compelling agentic products, with the launch of Grok Bot positioning the company to better compete within the massive enterprise AI opportunity. Looking ahead, we expect the impressive pace & quality of model releases to continue, with SpaceX aiming to introduce new models on a monthly cadence through 2H26. **Grok 5, expected by December, should represent a substantial step up in scale & capability,** & we believe the combination of Cursor data & SpaceX's ~25 years of proprietary internal company data should further improve the model's coding & real-world engineering capabilities. Overall, while near-term AI revenue is largely driven by premium compute deals (\$30-\$50/watt), we expect improving Grok monetization, particularly among enterprises, to become an increasingly important driver over time. **We remain Overweight rated on SPCX shares & our \$240 PT is based on 34x our 2028E GAAP EPS of \$7.02.** We note that the next lock-up expirations take place on September 9 & 10 when nearly 370M shares unlock, potentially increasing the float by 20%. See our lock-up expiration schedule in Figure 3 for more details.

Key Innovations & Upcoming Releases

- Grok 4.6 Among The Frontier.** On 8/12, [SpaceX announced Grok 4.6](#), which builds on Grok 4.5 (released 7/16) & represents a notable improvement in intelligence, particularly across agentic capabilities. Grok 4.6 achieves a score of 61 on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index, tied with GPT 5.6-Sol, & trailing only Anthropic's Claude Fable 5 & Claude Opus 5. The model was built with a focus on long-running agents & trained on a wide range of agentic RL tasks, supported by curated, high quality data spanning advanced technical concepts & engineering. Importantly, Grok 4.6 offers this level of intelligence at a fraction of the cost of peers, with pricing starting at \$2/\$6 per M input/output tokens, positioning it on the intelligence vs cost-per-task Pareto frontier. While Grok still trails peers in terms of adoption, we believe the combination of frontier intelligence & cost efficiency should support broader traction among developers & enterprises.

See page 7 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

Overweight

SPCX, SPCX US

Price (24 Aug 26):\$135.00

Price Target (Dec-27):\$240.00

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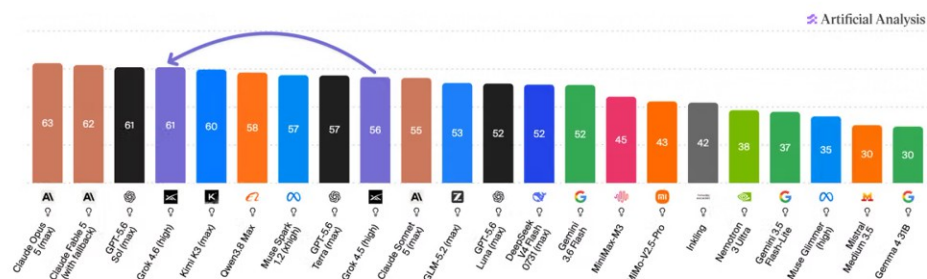
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- Grok Bot in Early Beta.** On 8/11, [SpaceX introduced Grok Bot](#), a team of always-on agents that execute real work across the apps & websites employees already use. Users create persistent Bots, assign each a role, & delegate work as they would a teammate. The Bots can operate app interfaces directly, retain memory across tasks, & coordinate with one another. SpaceX has been using the product internally across engineering, growth, & marketing, & Grok Bot is now in beta on desktop & iOS for SuperGrok Heavy, Cursor Ultra, & Cursor Teams premium subscribers. Early feedback from beta users has been positive, & we are encouraged by SpaceX's efforts to develop more capable, agentic products & better compete in the fast-growing market for enterprise AI agents.
- Grok 4.7 Imminent & Grok 5 by Year-End.** We expect the rapid pace of model innovation to continue, with SpaceX planning to release new models on a monthly cadence through the end of the year. Grok 4.7 should be announced in early September & is described by Elon as “better than 4.6 in every way, except slightly slower to serve, albeit with even better token efficiency.” The initial training of Grok 4.7 is already complete & SpaceX is leveraging its unique corpus of company data in supplemental training to enhance the model's engineering capabilities. Looking further ahead, we expect Grok 5 to be released by year-end & should represent an even more significant improvement in intelligence & overall capabilities. We believe the model is training on the Colossus 2 Blackwell supercluster & is expected to have 6T+ parameters, with anticipated improvements across coding/engineering capabilities, agentic behavior, multi-step reasoning, & video understanding.

Figure 1: Grok 4.6 Represents Significant Improvement vs. Grok 4.5

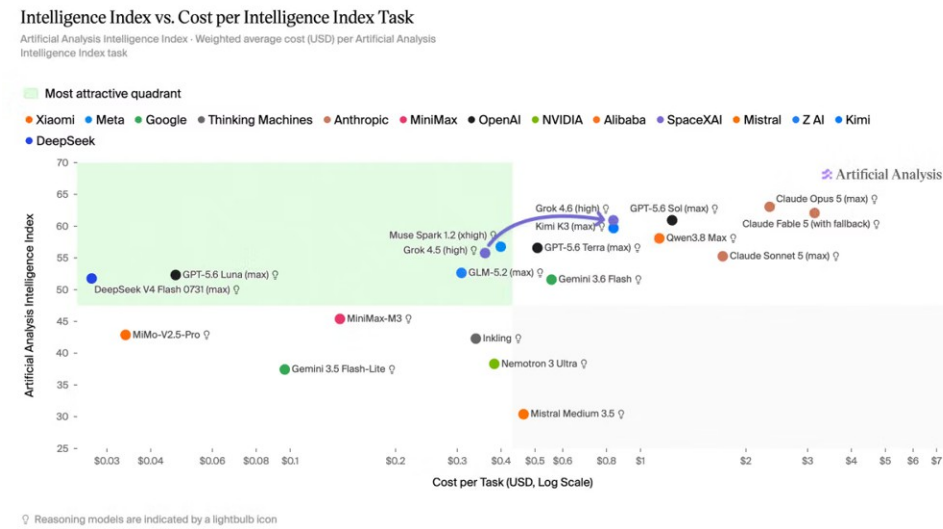
Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index

Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index v4.1.1 incorporates 9 evaluations: GDPval-AA v2, r², Banking, Terminal-Bench v2.1, SciCode, Humanity's Last Exam, GPQA Diamond, CritPt, AA-Omniscience, AA-LCR



Source: Artificial Analysis

Figure 2: Grok 4.6 Positioned On The Intelligence vs. Cost-Per-Task Pareto Frontier



Source: Artificial Analysis

Figure 3: SPCX Lock-Up Schedule

Date	Days from Prospectus	Shares Unlocking (SU)	Float	Float as % of Total	% increase in float	SU as % of Total
180 Day Shares						
06/11/2026	0		639	5%		
2Q26 + 2 days (8/6/2026)	56	911.5	1,550	12%	143%	7%
08/20/2026	70	319.0	1,869	14%	21%	2%
09/09/2026	90	319.0	2,188	17%	17%	2%
09/10/2026	91	59.1	2,247	17%	3%	0%
09/24/2026	105	328.4	2,576	20%	15%	3%
10/09/2026	120	328.4	2,904	22%	13%	3%
10/24/2026	135	328.4	3,233	25%	11%	3%
3Q26 + 2 days		1,300.0	4,533	34%	40%	10%
12/08/2026	180	797.6	5,330	41%	18%	6%
365+ Day Shares						
4Q26 + 2 days		351.9	5,682	43%	7%	3%
03/18/2027	280	176.0	5,858	45%	3%	1%
1Q27 + 2 days		351.9	6,210	47%	6%	3%
05/17/2027	340	176.0	6,386	49%	3%	1%
06/12/2027	366	351.9	6,738	51%	6%	3%
06/12/2027	366	6,400.0	13,138	100%	95%	49%
2Q27 + 2 days		351.9	13,490			3%

Source: Company Reports & J.P. Morgan Estimates.

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Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

SpaceX (Overweight; Price Target: \$240.00)

Investment Thesis

SpaceX's ambitions are bigger than any company's we've seen—to make life multi-planetary, leverage the Sun to build out AI in space, & build bases on the Moon and cities on other planets. In our view, no other company is as well positioned to go after the combined anticipated TAM of \$28T+. Launch is the key enabler & differentiator, with ~670 orbital launches, a 99%+ success rate, & 80%+ of all mass to orbit since 2023. Starship should deliver a 10x cost improvement & ~4x higher payload vs. Falcon 9. We expect launches to go from a handful in 2026 to ~5,000 in 2031. Extreme vertical integration & an engineering-first culture let SpaceX build faster & cheaper. Connectivity drives current financials via Starlink, the largest LEO constellation. We see broadband subscribers growing from 9M in 2025 to 95M+ in 2030. On mobile, we see optionality over time, with an MVNO more likely to emerge in international markets first, where Starlink Mobile may convert existing revenue-sharing agreements. Importantly, AI is expected to be the long-term driver, as SpaceX is modeled to ramp terrestrial compute from 2.2GW in '26E to 8.6GW by the end of 2028. From 2029 on, we expect SpaceX to pursue orbital compute towards ~75GW by the end of 2031 at a significantly cheaper cost than could be done on Earth. We believe significant upside potential remains as the company quite literally builds out the next frontier.

Valuation

Our December 2027 price target of \$240 is based on ~34x our 2028E GAAP EPS of \$7.02. We believe SPCX warrants a premium to its mega-cap peers (Mag7 + PLTR) trading at a median of ~20x, justified by market leadership across launch, connectivity, & AI. The financial profile further supports the multiple as we model total revenue scaling from \$19B in 2025 to \$196B in 2028E (119% CAGR vs. 26% average for the comps) and GAAP Operating Income margin expanding from -14% in 2025 to ~44% in 2028E (vs. 38% average for the comps in '28E).

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Key downside risks include:

- **Everything Depends on Starship:** Rapid & complete reusability is the critical enabler underpinning SpaceX's long-term growth drivers, expected to structurally lower launch costs ~80%+ vs. legacy; any delays, technical setbacks, or regulatory hurdles would impede growth across multiple business lines given Starship's scale & complexity.
- **Supply Constraints, Especially in AI:** Bottlenecks in power availability & silicon/chip supply could delay constellation buildout, moderate launch cadence, & weigh on gross margins, with reliance on advanced chips adding geopolitical/trade exposure; the industry-wide nature of these constraints makes them hard to fully mitigate, though Terafab first-party chip manufacturing is anticipated in the outer years.
- **Extremely Strong Execution Required:** Continued execution across existing & more ambitious initiatives will inevitably bring unforeseen challenges given the scale, complexity, & frontier nature of what SpaceX is pursuing; while many years ahead, competition is picking up—from Blue Origin, AMZN, & international players—which could pressure pricing, win rates, & R&D spend over time.

- **Heavy Capital Intensity & Near-Term FCF Burn:** The front-loaded multi-year investment cycle across Starship, Starlink, & compute drives \$300B+ of forecast negative FCF & debt proceeds over 2026-2030, with positive FCF not modeled until 2031; cost overruns or scale delays could extend the burn & increase capital raise needs, despite the recent transactions (\$85B+ IPO + \$25B debt raised).
- **Regulatory:** Export controls, ITAR, spectrum allocation, & environmental reviews (particularly around Starship) could moderate launch pace or market access & introduce timing variability; these dynamics are inherently hard to forecast, though the current backdrop has generally emphasized streamlining rather than friction.
- **There's Only One Elon:** Elon Musk's outsized influence & control (~82% voting power) has been a defining driver of success, but that concentration raises governance considerations & key-man/leadership-transition risk, with "controlled company" status under Nasdaq rules meaning more limited board independence.

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SpaceX (SPCX, SPCX US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (\$)	Price Target (\$)
07-Jul-26	OW	160.42	225
05-Aug-26	OW	125.33	240

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 07, 2026. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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